

1950, March 4th

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX FRIARY

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

March 4th, 1950

Mrs. E.L. Eichhorn, R.N.
Bay City, Michigan

Dear Mrs. Eichhorn:

God bless you these days of unrest and suspense - you and yours. I have read your pathetic letter and do surely sympathize with you and your dear ones. I hope that the good God may manifest something of His merciful designs in favoring you with such a peculiar cross; for indeed, from sacred history the truth of the old saying - of St. Paul (?): "Whom the Lord loveth He chasteneth", is most manifest.

We've had several cases similar to yours and some of them altogether more tragic and hopeless - turn out to have been indeed real blessings in disguise. A single example: It must be ten or more years ago that a certain modest lady, having waited close to an hour, till all else had gone, introduced herself: "...I's not Catholic, but I would like to get a bessin too. I's always had head-aches". Her accent rather than her color indicated something of her particular origin.

About three hours later a well featured but very dark visitor of the same name and identical accent asked for a rosary. I told him of his namesake who had been in about 11 a.m. "That's my Wife". She had come home without any headache. Glory be to God! They had been praying for a family for thirteen years and were naturally discouraged or becoming so. They believed in Christianity but had never been baptized.It is next to "Unbelievable", what difficulties they met with and, by God's grace overcame, before being received into the Church, and even for months afterwards. All Hell just seemed determined to shake them from their purpose.

We make it a point to stress the importance of making sacrifice in recognition of a favor received - having started out with an understanding, at least to that effect. For Catholics, e.g., more frequent holy Communion if favor is granted and preferable, by all means to start at once - to "get ahead of the Good God in generosity" if possible. For non-catholics, that they be earnest in looking into something of the claims of the Church; or something of the relationship - dependence of the denominations on the Mother-Church, etc and working accordingly.